UPFRONT

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IANS

DEMANDING ANSWERS NSUI members protest against the OSM 'irregularities' at the CBSE office, Delhi, May 28

▶ CBSE EVALUATION

A SCREENFUL OF BUNGLES

Designed to modernise evaluation, the Central Board of Secondary Education's On-Screen Marking system instead sparked controversy over wrong answer sheets and unexplained scores. As inquiries begin, the focus shifts to accountability and rebuilding trust

By SHELLY ANAND

On June 2, the Union government removed Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) chairman Rahul Singh and secretary Himanshu Gupta with immediate effect. It was the clearest sign that the row over the board's new On-Screen Marking (OSM) system had stopped being a result-season grievance and become a governance crisis. The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet installed Lokhande Prashant Sitaram, a 2001-batch IAS officer from the Union home ministry, as the new chairperson, and Varun Bhardwaj of the Indian Information Service as secretary.

Gupta has been repatriated to his parent cadre on "administrative grounds" and barred from another central posting until December 2030. The move makes him the chief bureaucratic casualty of the fiasco, even though, on May 28, Union education minister Dharmendra Pradhan accepted responsibility for it. The Cabinet Secretariat has now constituted a one-man committee under S. Radha Chauhan, who heads the Capacity Building Commission, to inquire into the procurement of the OSM system and report within a month.